

813 gas generators. One customer, at first.

El Paso Electric wants to build them beside Meta's AI data center in northeast El Paso County. Two judges recommend approval with a condition on who pays, and denial without it.



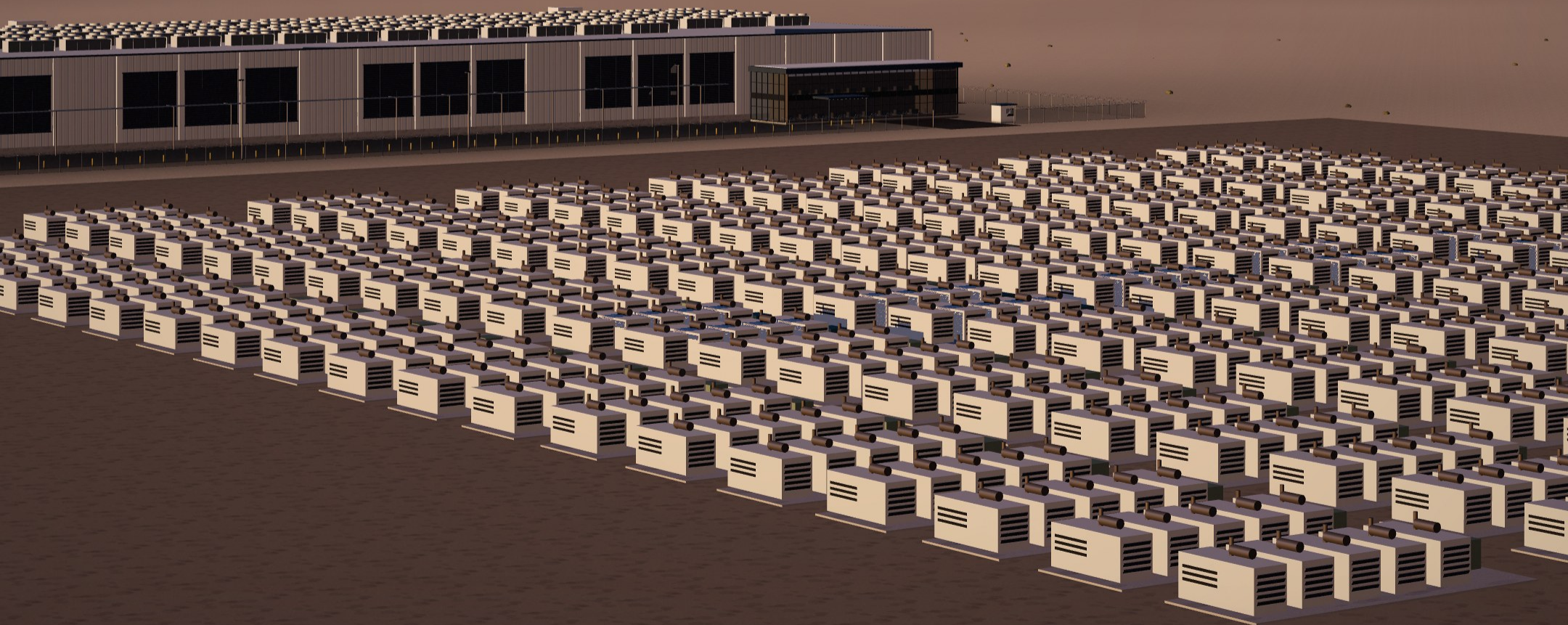
Four or five to a transformer

The plan would buy 813 modular gas generators rated at 450 kilowatts each. They are typically installed in groups of four or five, each group connected to a step-up transformer.



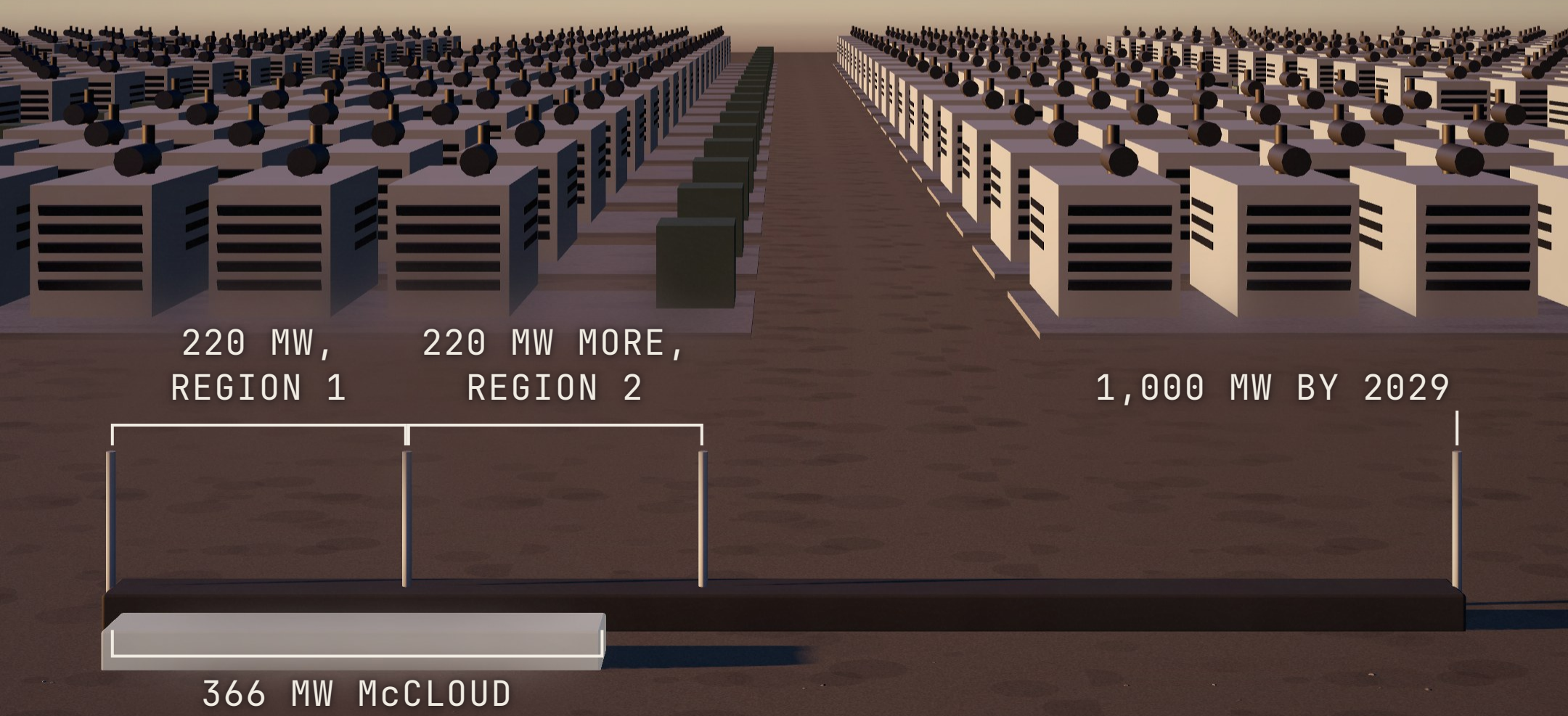
About 31 acres beside the data center

The McCloud plant would sit on already-disturbed land immediately next to the data center, which Worldwide LLC, owned by Meta, is developing. Its generators would run islanded, fed by a natural gas pipeline.



366 MW against 1,000

The data center has committed to 1,000 MW by the end of 2029. The judges found existing resources can serve about the first 220 MW of its load, and the second 220 MW requires additional capacity.



Need shown. Cost and alternatives, not.

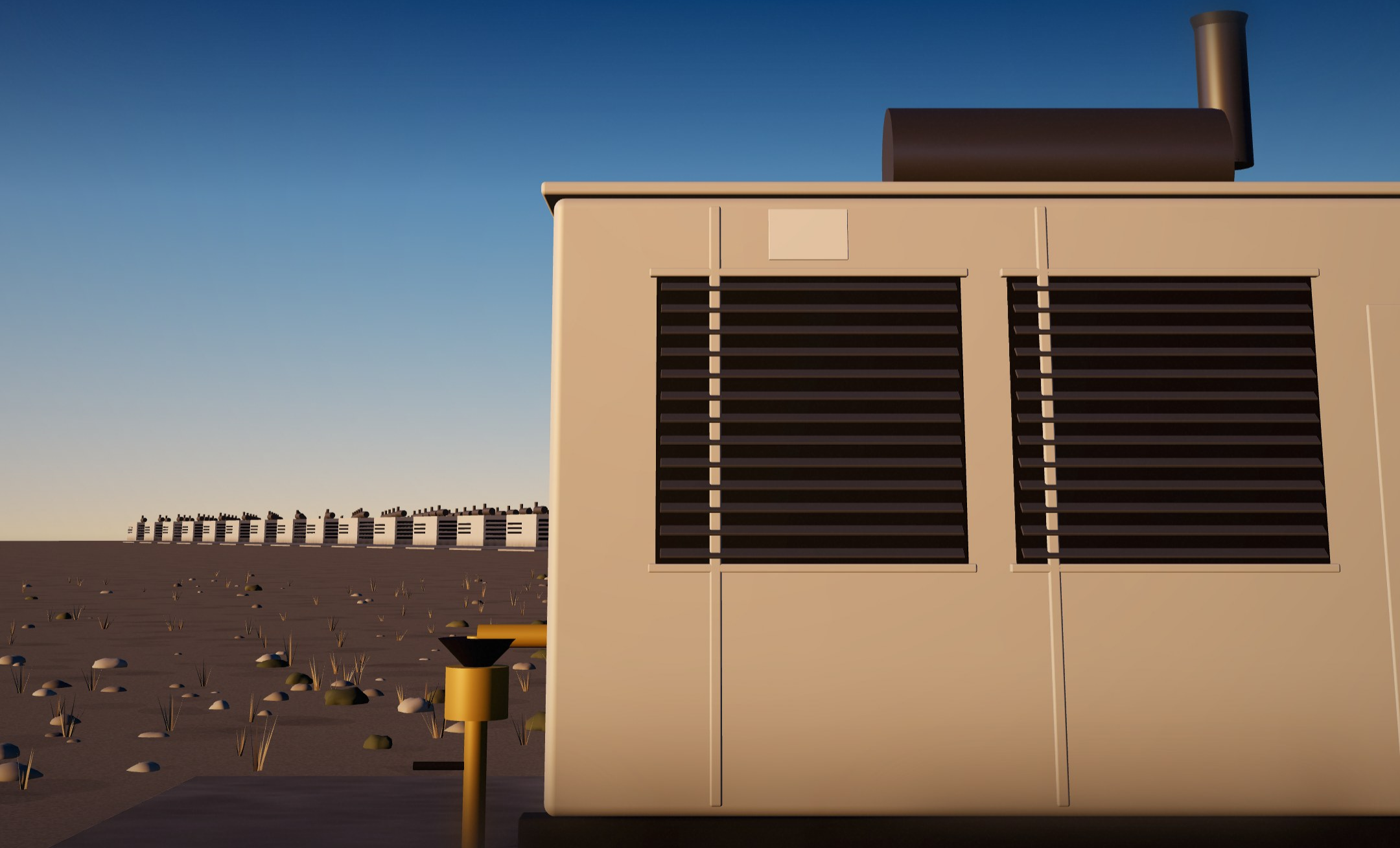
The two judges filed their proposal for decision on September 23rd. They found the utility showed a need for capacity to serve the data center.

"did not show that the McCloud facility is a cost-effective and reliable resource"

"failed to show that it adequately considered alternatives"

The vendor the data center preferred

El Paso Electric engaged Enchanted Rock after the data center preferred it. It considered no other vendor, issued no request for proposals and ran no cost-benefit analysis for ratepayers. The plant would be its first experience with modular gas generation.



Up to five years, then no decision

El Paso Electric proposes a bridge of up to five years in which the data center pays all the plant's capital costs. Its witness testified that no decision has been made on who pays after that. Its chief executive told KVIA it isn't seeking to shift those costs onto residential or other customers.

YEAR 20, ESTIMATED SERVICE LIFE

UP TO YEAR 5, BRIDGE

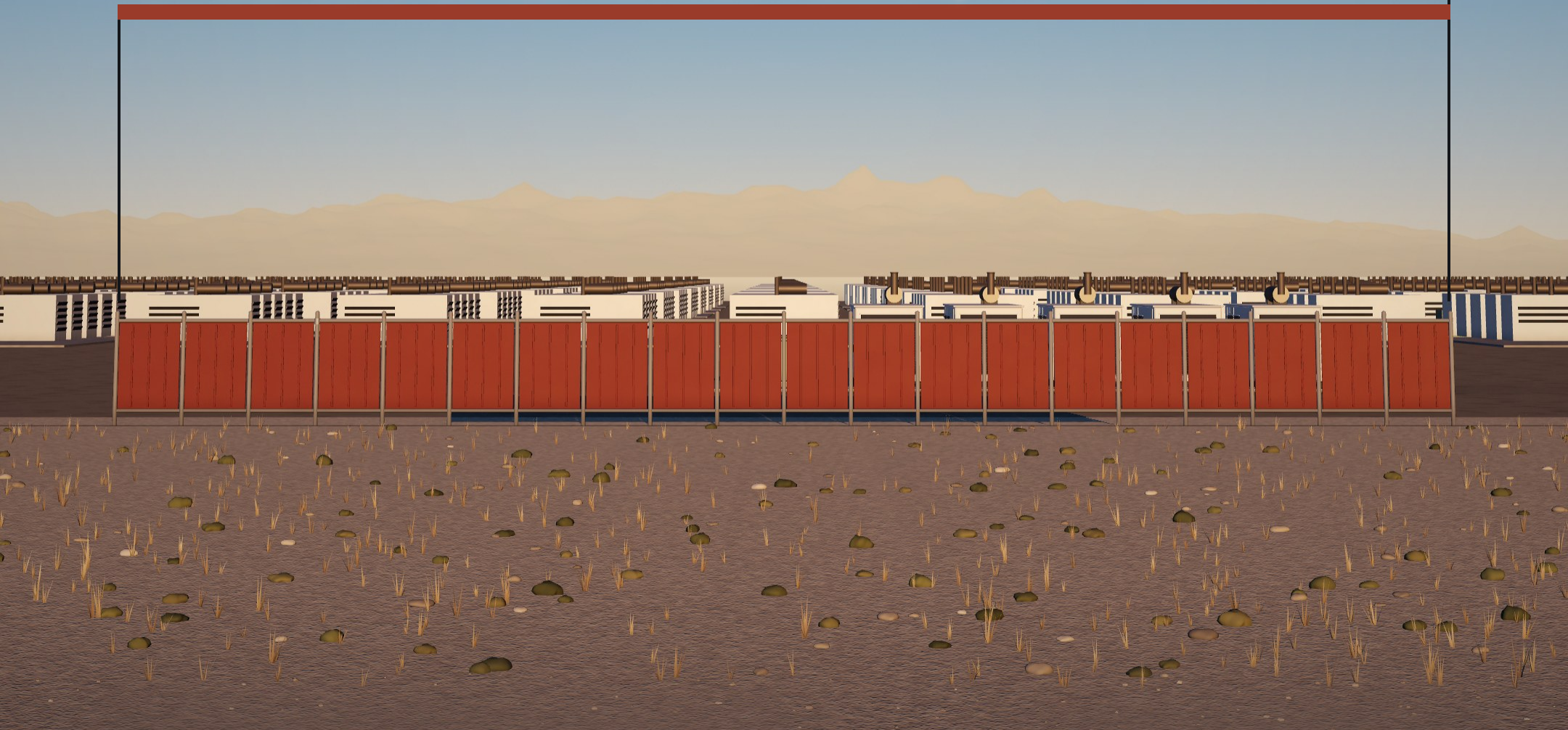


For the life of the plant

The judges recommend approval only if the utility's other customers pay none of the plant's capital and operating costs, unless the plant later meets the statute's test. Its generation facilities are estimated at about \$499.8 million. El Paso City Council has authorized a counteroffer for a full hold harmless.

OTHER CUSTOMERS PAY NONE

For the life of the McCloud facility



The commission has not ruled

KVIA reports that five commissioners will accept, change or reject the proposal and that a final order is expected by December 7th. Docket 59076 on the PUCT Interchange holds comments from 1118 protestors and a residential customer.